Investigator Name: Bibek Pandeya
Date of Investigation: October 27, 2026
Target Machine: bibek

1. Executive Summary:

At approximately 1:37 PM on October 27, 2026, an unknown threat actor conducted a local brute-force attack against the workstation. The attacker successfully breached the system at 1:38 PM. Upon gaining access, the attacker established persistence by creating a rogue local administrator account and modifying the current user's Registry Run keys to execute a malicious payload on startup. Furthermore, suspicious command-line activity was detected indicating the use of hidden PowerShell execution.

2. Authentication Analysis:

- **Failed Logins Detected:** Yes (5 consecutive failures observed)
- **Event ID Used to track failures:** 4625 (Audit Failure)
- **Timestamp of failed logins:** 10/27/2026 1:37:08 PM – 1:37:27 PM
- **Timestamp of successful login:** 10/27/2026 1:38:42 PM (Event ID 4624)
- **Logon Type:** Type 2 (Interactive)
- **Significance:** A Type 2 logon confirms the attacker was physically sitting at the keyboard of the target machine during the attack, rather than attacking over the network. . [Appendix 1 & 2]

3. Persistence & Privilege Escalation:

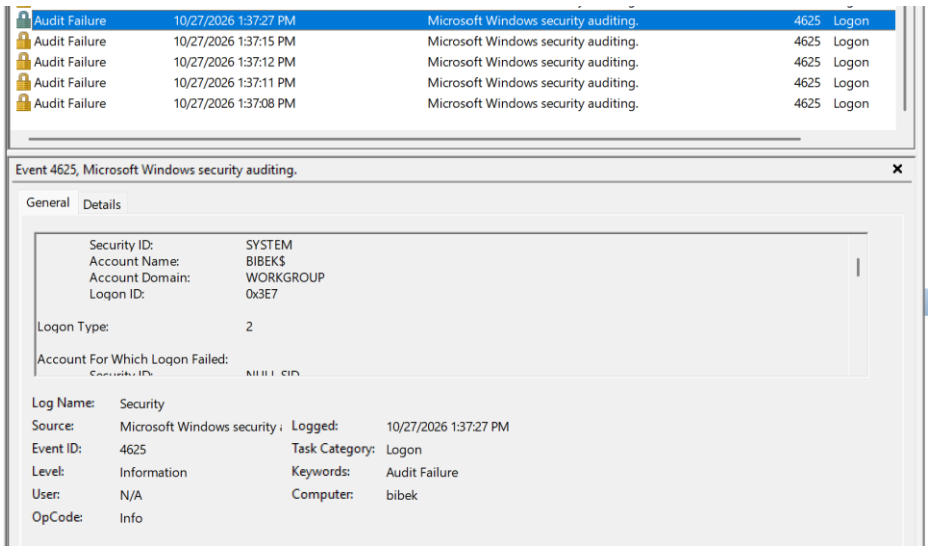
- **Rogue Account Created:** Yes
- **Event ID Used to track creation:** 4720 (Audit Success)
- **Timestamp of Account Creation:** 10/27/2026 1:40:05 PM
- **Name of the Rogue Account:** EvilHacker
- **Account that executed the creation:** bibek
- **Registry Run Key Discovered:** Yes
- **Registry Key Name:** FakeVirusUpdate
- **Target Path of Malware:** C:\Users\Public\virus.exe

- **Significance:** The attacker ensured that even if their initial session was terminated, they could re-enter the system using the EvilHacker account, and their malware would automatically run every time the compromised user logged in. [Appendix 3 & 4]

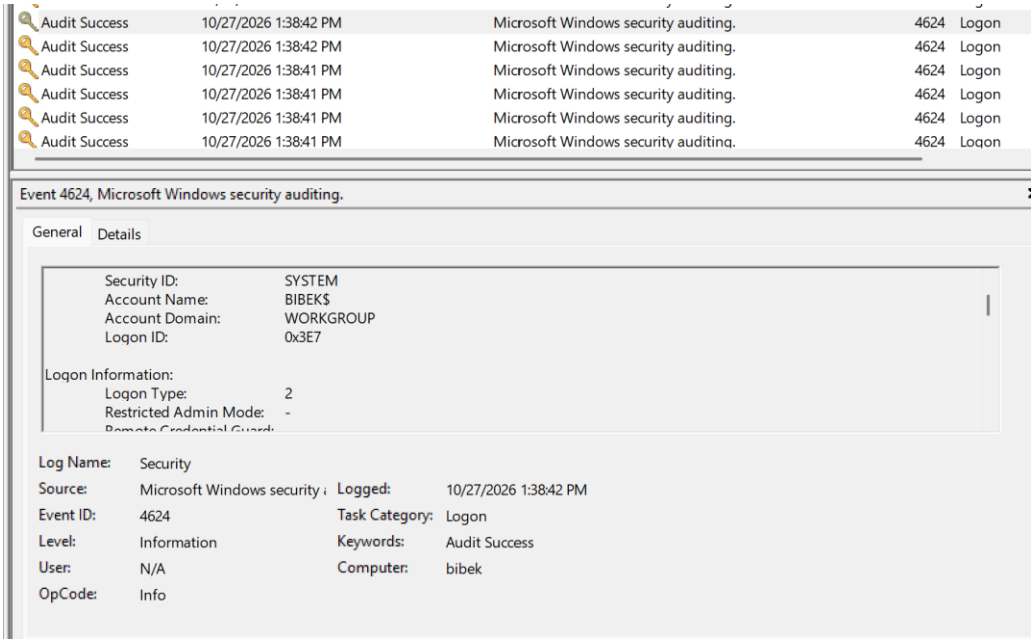
4. Process Execution Analysis:

- **Suspicious Process Detected:** Yes
- **Event ID Used:** 4688 (Process Creation)
- **Timestamp of Execution:** 10/27/2026 1:59:38 PM
- **Parent Process (Creator):** C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
- **Child Process (New Process):** C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe
- **Significance:** The attacker used the standard Command Prompt to spawn a PowerShell instance, a classic "Living off the Land" technique used to hide malicious commands within legitimate Windows tools. . [Appendix 5]
-

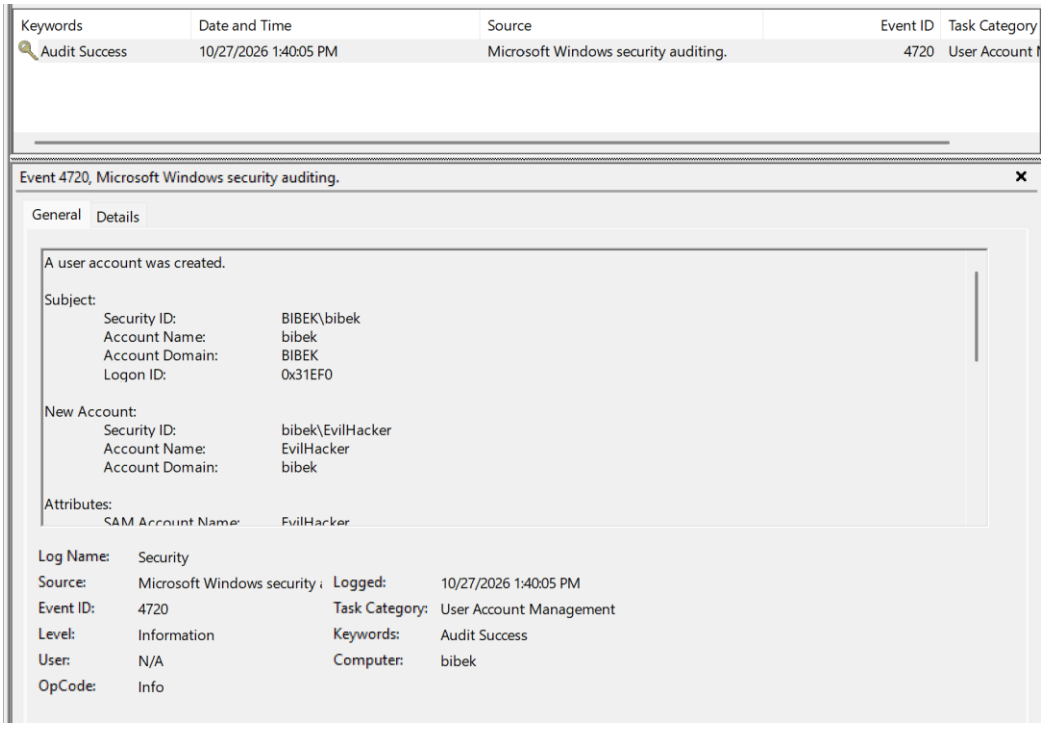
Appendixes:



Appendix 1 : Failed Logon events



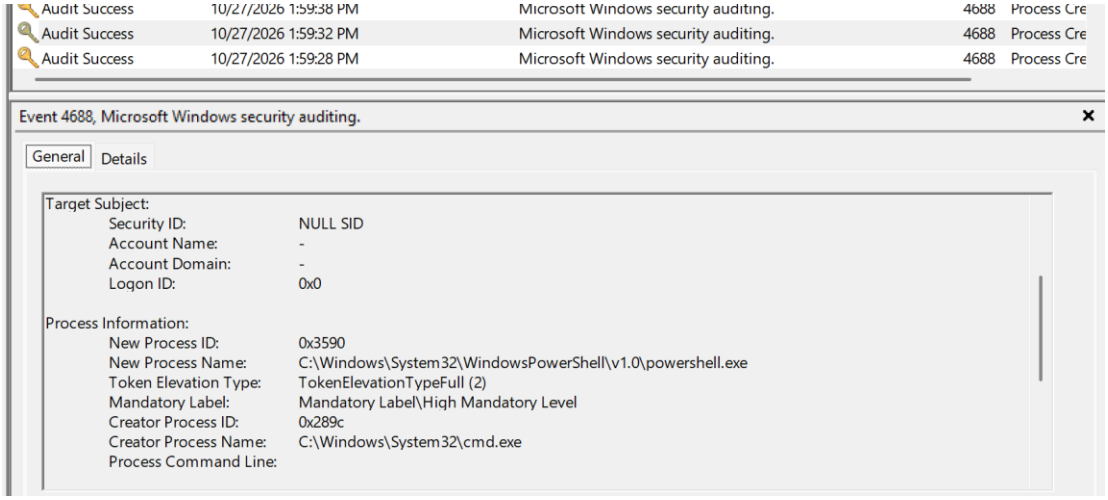
Appendix 2 : Successful Logon events



Appendix 3 : New account creation [Persistence]

```
FakeVirusUpdate                 : C:\Users\Public\virus.exe
PSPath                          : Microsoft.PowerShell.Core\Registry::HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Softwa
                                  re\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run
PSParentPath                    : Microsoft.PowerShell.Core\Registry::HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Softwa
                                  re\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion
PSChildName                     : Run
PSDrive                         : HKCU
PSProvider                      : Microsoft.PowerShell.Core\Registry
```

Appendix 4: Auto run malware



Appendix 5 : **Process Execution**